THE MONTH IN FILM · DAVIDEHRLICH

Fifty Films, One Horned-Up Tree, and a Camp at the End of the World

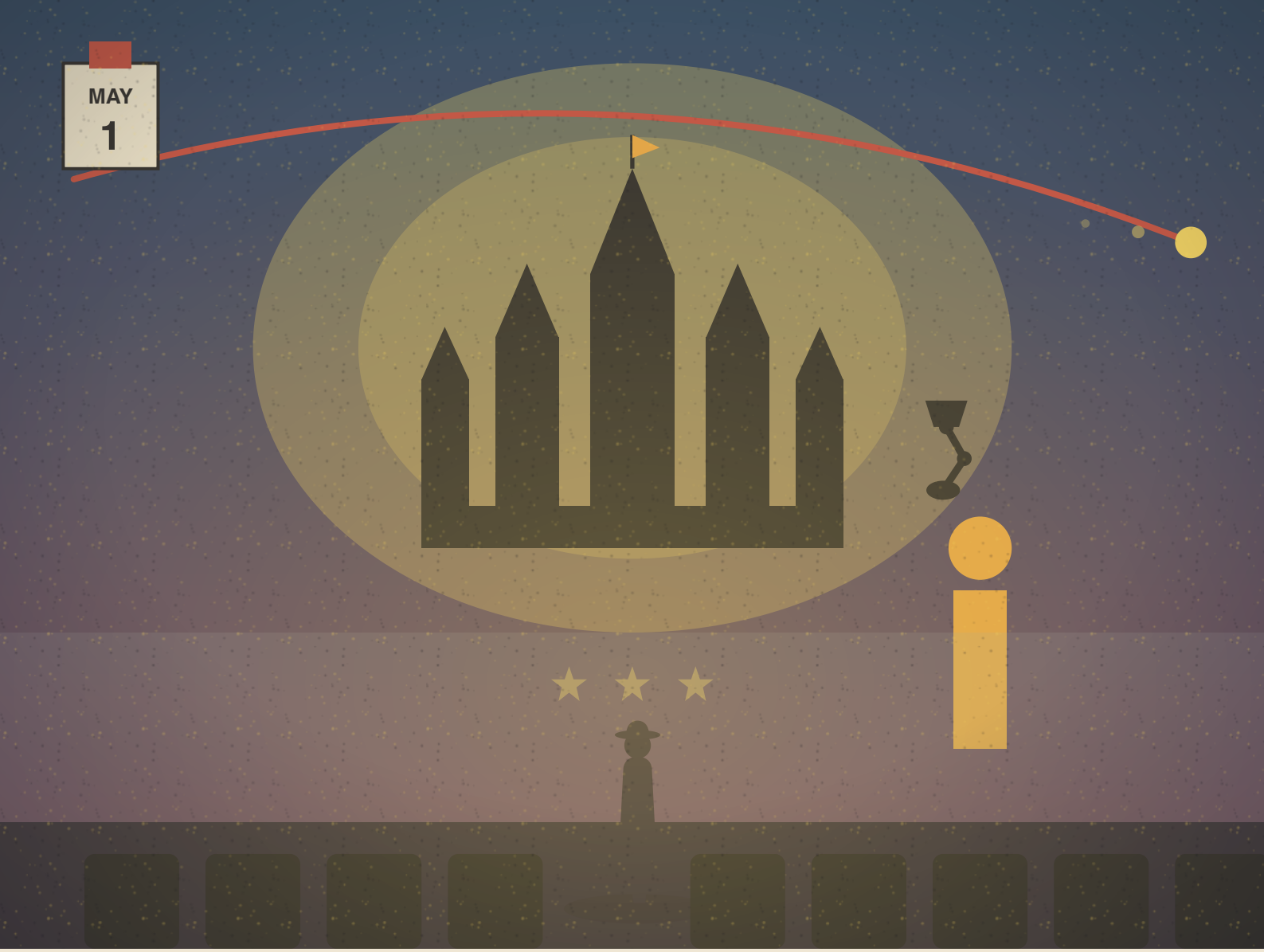
David Ehrlich's eight-week crawl from Pixar nostalgia to 100 consecutive lifetimes in horny jail

May 1 – Jun 26 · 50 films · mean 3.15★ · 49 directors



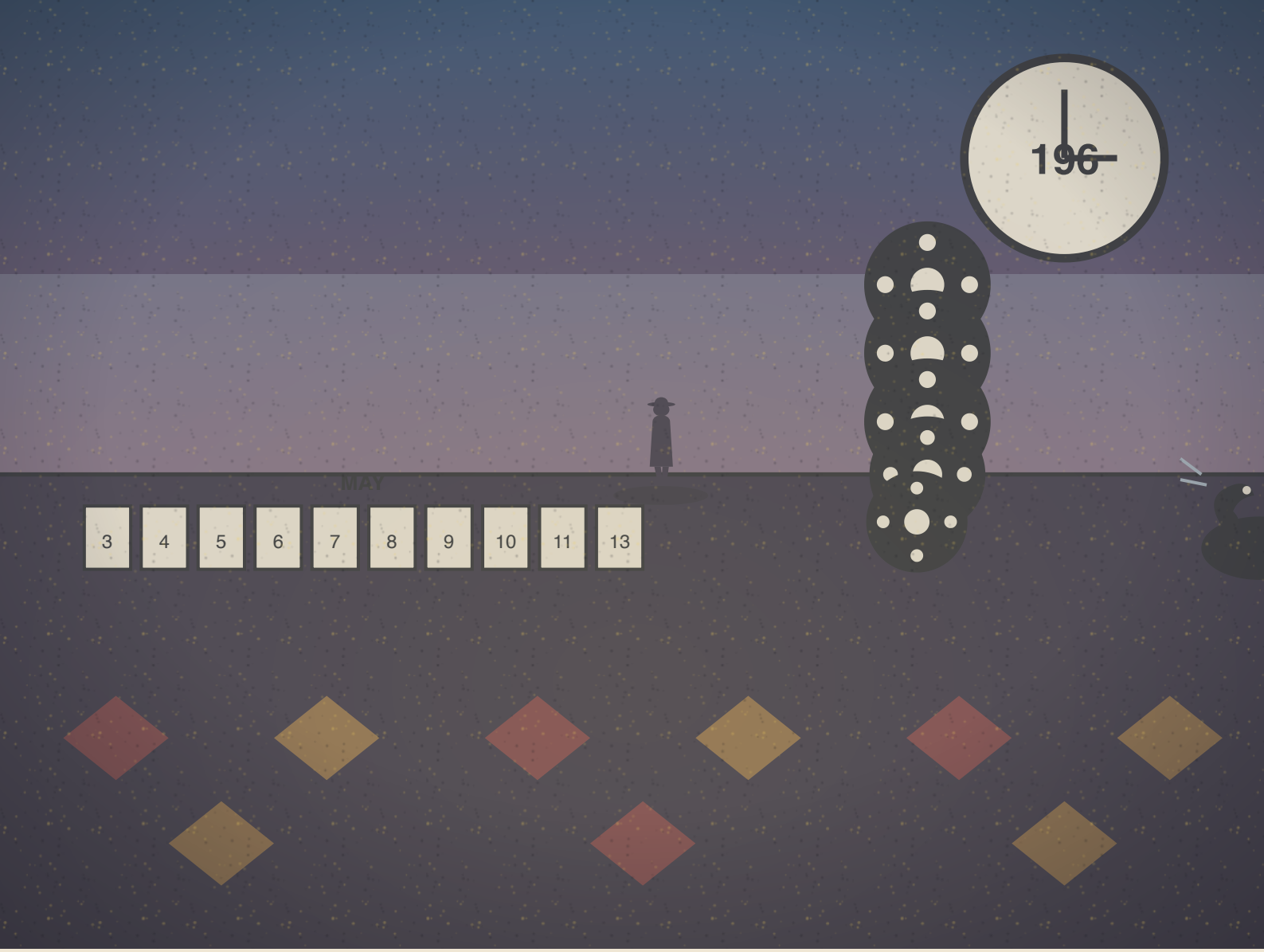


DUSK PROJECTOR: A CRITIC'S FEVER REEL



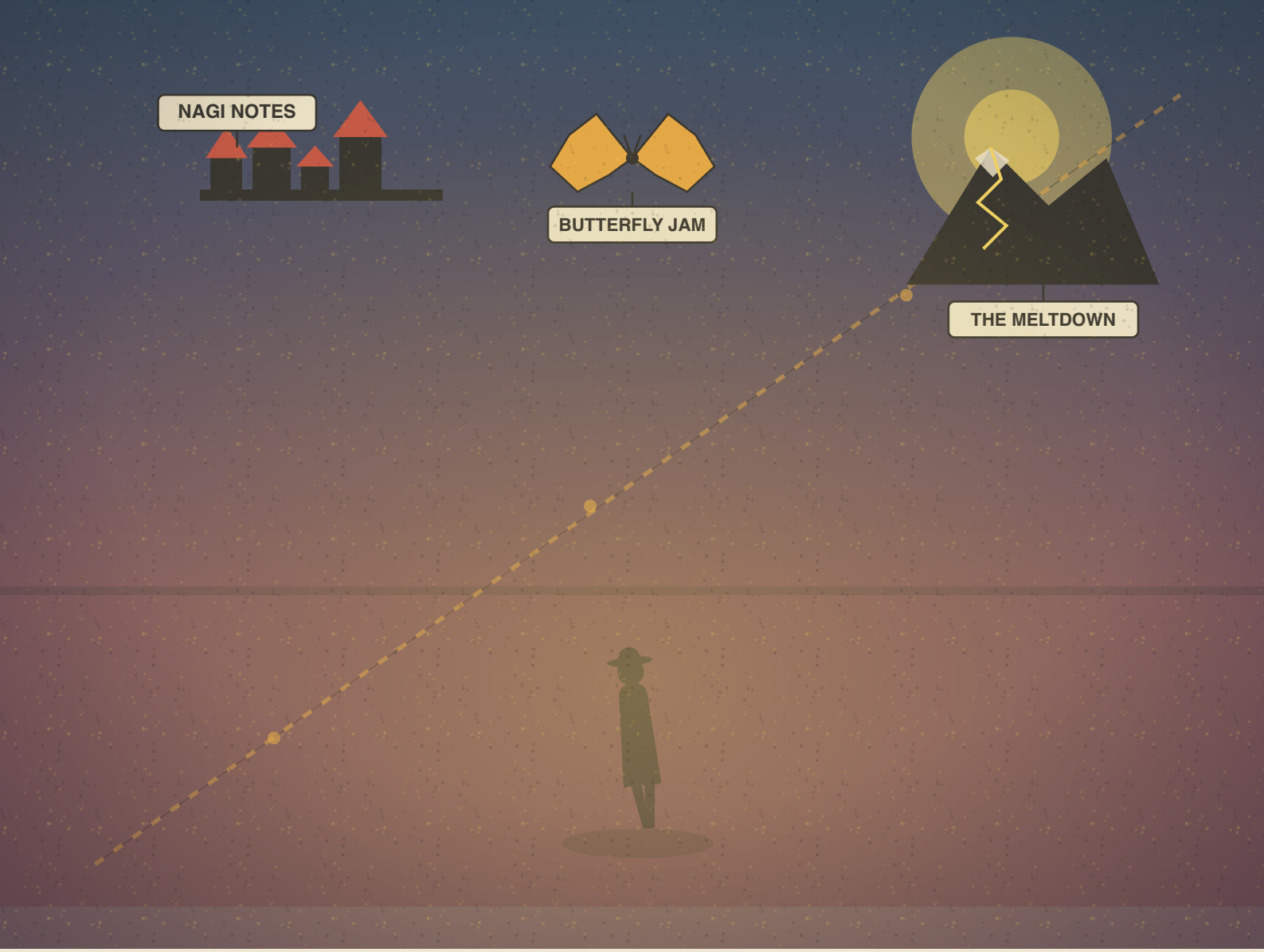
THE PAVLOVIAN BELL

May 1: the reflex still fires — a shooting star arching over the Disney castle, Luxo Jr. hopping onto that Pixar 'i,' and Ehrlich's pulse doing the thing it always does. Three stars for Swapped. The clock starts on fifty films and eight weeks of appetite.



TEN DAYS NOTHING, THEN EVERYTHING

Ten days of silence, then twenty-nine films avalanche in — a 196-minute meeting that 'almost feels redundant,' a Farhadi that forfeits the sordid humanity it's chasing, and Fatherland, dispatched with a tired honk-shoo honk-shoo. Average: 3.09, and dropping.



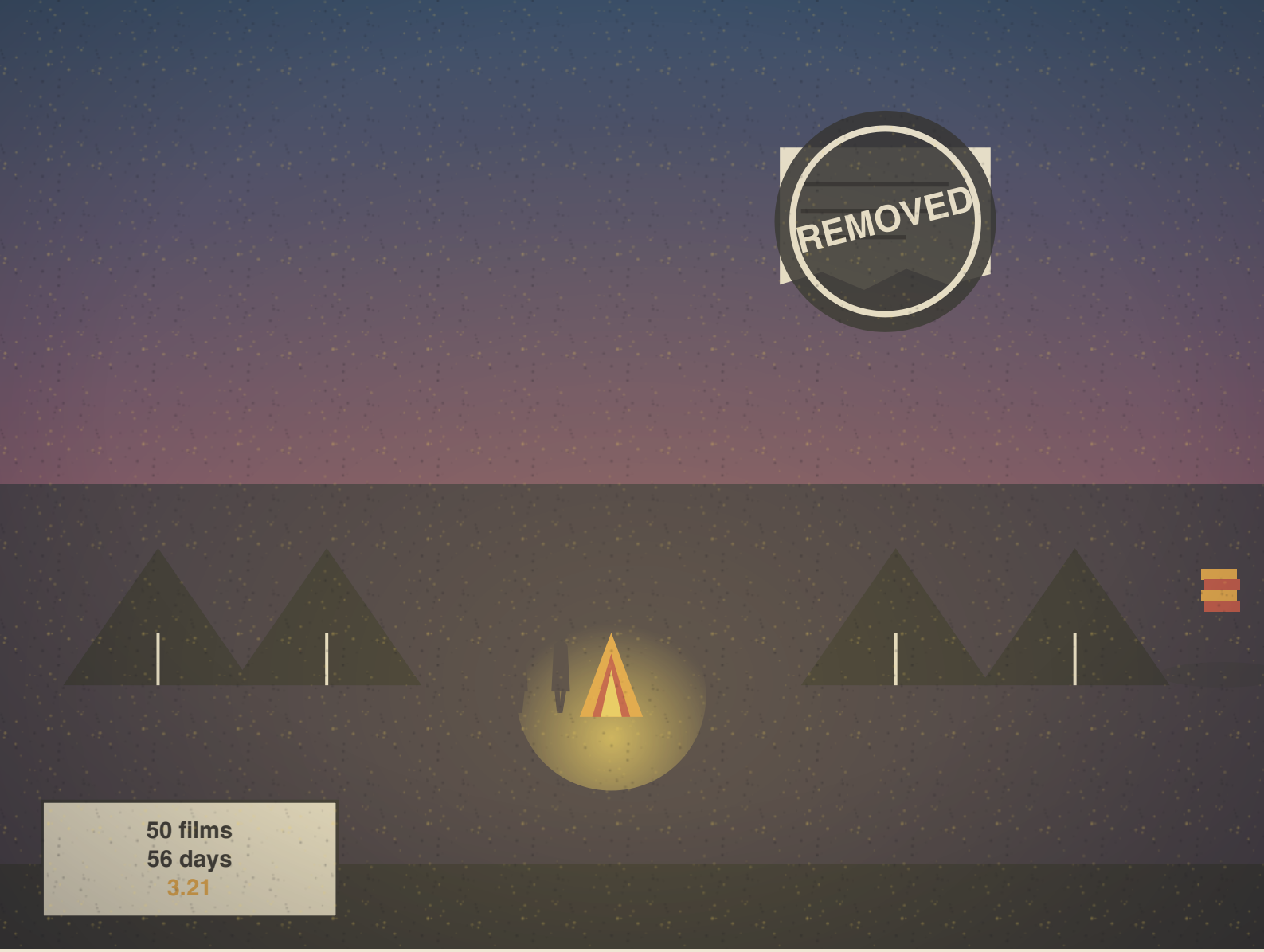
SECOND BINGE, BETTER COMPANY

May 22: Ehrlich starts naming names — Fukada's small-town textures, Balagov's shambling, arrestingly strange nerve, a Pinochet ghost dragged up out of The Meltdown. The average ticks to 3.2; drama loosens its grip; something like curiosity comes back.



THE HORNED-UP TREE

Then the tree: that is a giant, hormonal, unbearably horned up 900-year-old virgin that understands loneliness, and somehow it's the tenderest thing on the calendar. Paper Tiger takes the run's high score, 4.5 stars, while Gentle Monster just lets Léa Seydoux plunk out Charles & Eddie and breathe.



SENTENCED TO HORNY JAIL

Five more dark days, then CAMP, riding comedy's late swing straight past Teenage Sex and Death at Camp Miasma — a review famously cut off mid-sentence: 'this review has been removed by the moderators, and its author sentenced to 100 consecutive lifetimes in horny jail. great movie tho.' Fifty films, fifty-six days, average 3.21 — Ehrlich walks off the lot, still humming honk-shoo honk-shoo.